

Module 08: Planning — Designing the Game

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Planning** is designing a future that hasn't happened yet.
2. Learn about **Game Design** (Creating rules for fun).
3. Know that if a game isn't fun, you can CHANGE the rules (Iteration).

Introduction: The Master Builder

Who invented Tag? Who invented Chess? People did! They used their Planning Brains to design a System. You are not just a Player. You are a **Designer**.

Key Concepts

1. The Goal (What is the point?)

Every game needs a destination.

- "Get to the end of the board." (Candyland).
- "Score the most points." (Basketball).
- "Don't get caught." (Tag). Without a goal, it's just running around.

2. Balancing (The Goldilocks Rule)

- If a game is too hard -> We quit (Frustration).
- If a game is too easy -> We quit (Boredom).
- If a game is JUST RIGHT -> We play for hours (Flow). A Designer has to balance the difficulty.

3. Iteration (Playtesting)

Your first idea might not work.

- "Let's play Tag where you can't run."
- (Everyone walks).
- "This is boring. Let's change it. Now you have to hop!"
- (Everyone hops).
- "Better!" Designing is testing and fixing.

Activities

Activity 1: The Remix

Take a boring game (like Tic-Tac-Toe). Add ONE rule to make it better.

- "You can move a piece after you place it."
- "If you win, you have to sing a song." Test your new version.

Activity 2: Obstacle Course Design

Use pillows, chairs, and blankets. Design a course.

- "Jump over the river."
- "Crawl under the cave." Draw the plan on paper FIRST. Then build it.

Summary

The best games come from the best plans. When you design a game, you are creating a little world for your friends to live in.

References

- *Iggy Peck, Architect* by Andrea Beaty
- *Boxitects* by Kim Smith